Jurassic English™

Level 1: Foundation — Curriculum Model

AGES 4–8 · CEFR PRE-A1 → A1

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026–2027

10 Core Texts · 40 Lessons · A full-year curriculum for early years learners building their first relationship with narrative, language, and reasoning.

Level Overview

What Level 1 Builds

Level 1 establishes the **physiological and emotional preconditions** for academic reasoning. Learners are building their first relationship with narrative — discovering that stories carry emotional weight, that characters make choices, and that language is a tool for describing the world inside and outside themselves.

The Thinking Cycle

At Foundation level, the Thinking Cycle operates through **oral discourse**. Written CEIW is introduced only at its simplest level: a spoken Claim supported by a picture or a sentence.

Regulation Protocol

The regulation protocol is **highly physical**: bilateral tapping, movement, and sensory anchoring are essential — not supplementary.

The Four-Lesson Cycle at Level 1

Every core text is explored through a structured four-lesson cycle, moving learners from observation to reflection.

Lesson 1: Excavation

Analyze — Word Fossil Hunt: students identify emotional vocabulary through listening and observation.

Lesson 2: Strata

Evaluate — The Big Question: students form a position on a moral dilemma in the text.

Lesson 3: The Justification

Justify — Spoken CEIW: "I think ___ because ___" — contestable Claim with visual Evidence.

Lesson 4: The Impact

Reflect — Ecological Exit: connecting the text's meaning to the living world.

Core Text List — Books 1–5

FOUNDATION TEXTS

PRE-A1 → A1

1. Where the Wild Things Are — Maurice Sendak

Pre-A1 · Ages 4–6

Emotional regulation; arc of anger to safety; imaginative play as emotional processing.

2. The Giving Tree — Shel Silverstein

Pre-A1 · Ages 4–7

Moral reasoning: generosity vs. depletion; first ecological awareness (tree as living entity).

3. The Snowy Day — Ezra Jack Keats

Pre-A1 · Ages 4–6

Sensory narrative; observational description; simple cause-and-effect reasoning.

4. Sylvester and the Magic Pebble — William Steig

A1 · Ages 5–8

Identity, loss, and belonging; Claim-Evidence introduction using visual text evidence.

5. Stellaluna — Janell Cannon

A1 · Ages 5–8

Ecological integration; identity and belonging; difference vs. conformity.

Core Text List — Books 6–10

FOUNDATION TEXTS | A1 LEVEL

6. Frog and Toad are Friends — Arnold Lobel

A1 · Ages 5–8

Friendship dynamics; early dialogue analysis; simple character motive reasoning.

7. Owl at Home — Arnold Lobel

A1 · Ages 5–8

Ambiguity and self-deception; first encounter with an unreliable narrator concept (simplified).

8. Miss Rumphius — Barbara Cooney

A1 · Ages 6–8

Ecological stewardship; intergenerational responsibility; dream-to-reality narrative arc.

9. The Sneetches — Dr. Seuss

Pre-A1 · Ages 4–7

Social justice foundation; in/out group dynamics; satire at the simplest level.

10. Frederick — Leo Lionni

A1 · Ages 5–8

The value of the non-material; artistic contribution to community; ecocentric preparation.

CEIW at Level 1: What It Looks Like

At Foundation level, CEIW is **oral and visual — not written**. The framework scaffolds young learners into structured reasoning through spoken language and picture evidence.

1	C — Claim "I think the tree is _____ because _____."
2	E — Evidence "On the last page, the picture shows..."
3	I — Interpretation "This means the tree feels _____ because it gave everything it had."
4	W — Warrant "When you give everything away, you feel _____."

Assessment Note: Teacher listens for cause-and-effect connection, not grammatical precision. The quality of reasoning matters more than the form of expression at this level.

Regulation-Before-Reasoning at Level 1

Every lesson begins with a regulation protocol. This is **non-negotiable** — it is the physiological foundation upon which all reasoning is built.

Bilateral Tapping Protocol

Every lesson, without exception.

Students tap alternating shoulders **20 times** while taking slow breaths. Teacher models and counts aloud. Students place hands flat on desk when ready.

> "Tap with me. Left... right... left... right. Now breathe. When your hands are flat, your brain is ready."

Sensory Anchoring

Alternative protocol for grounding.

Students hold a **natural object** — a leaf, stone, or twig. **30 seconds of silent observation** before any academic discourse begins.

This anchors attention in the sensory present and prepares the nervous system for focused engagement with narrative and reasoning tasks.

Reasoning Progression at Level 1

The curriculum maps directly onto Bloom's Taxonomy, building from simple recall toward independent position-forming across the year.

Bloom's Level 1 — Recall

Identifying emotion words from read-aloud. Students name what they hear and see.

Bloom's Level 2 — Causality

"Max feels angry **BECAUSE** he was sent to his room." Students connect emotion to event.

Bloom's Level 3 — Application

Oral Claim sentence stem with peer exchange. Students apply reasoning to share a position.

Target CEFR Exit Standard: A1

Student can form an **independent position** using a picture as evidence. Progression Indicator: the Claim is their OWN opinion, not a repetition of a peer's.

Differentiation Approach

Every learner is met where they are. The three-tier model ensures access, challenge, and meaningful assessment for all students across the ability range.

Support

Pre-prepared feeling word cards with pictures. Teacher scribe available. Sentence stem provided on a laminated card for independent reference.

Core

Oral CEIW using picture evidence. Exit drawing with word label. Students demonstrate reasoning through image and spoken language.

Extension

Two contrasting Claim sentences. "Can you find two feelings that are **OPPOSITES** in the story?" Students explore complexity and contradiction.

Assessment Anchor: Exit drawing + word label. Teacher notes which students connect vocabulary to illustration *without prompting* — this is the CEFR A1 indicator.

Year at a Glance

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026–2027

40

Total Lessons

Structured across the full academic year

10

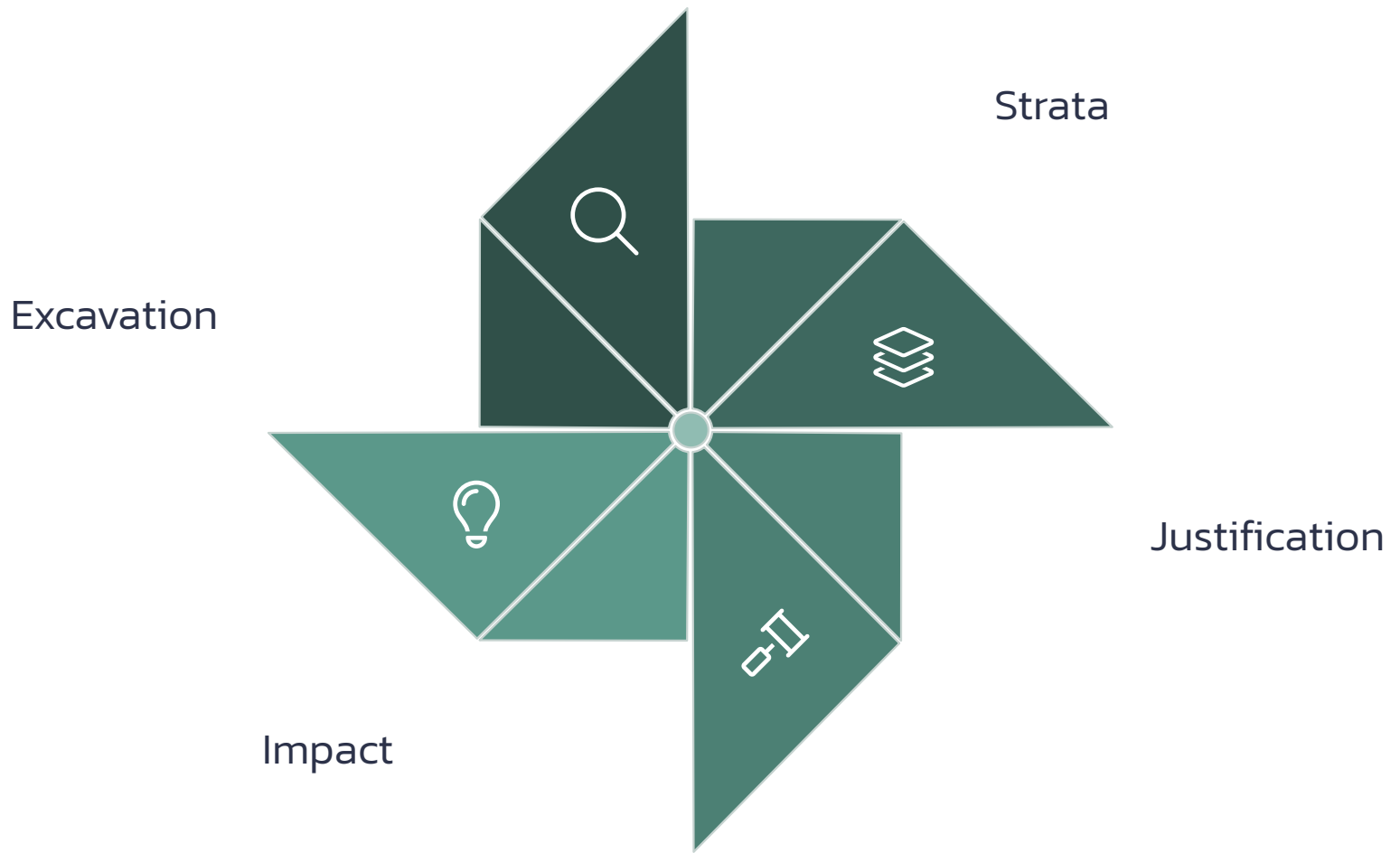
Core Texts

Each explored in a 4-lesson cycle

4

Cycle Phases

Excavation → Strata → Justification → Impact



Regulation-Before-Reasoning is embedded in **every lesson, every cycle** — non-negotiable. Assessment portfolio builds across the year: exit drawings and recorded oral claims from Term 1, written sentences introduced from Term 2 onward.